Gentle Rain

Weekly Curriculum Plan

Week 1 • 3/10 - 3/14

Age Group: 0–3 Years (Mixed Age)

Generated March 17, 2026

Weekly Theme Overview

*This week we explore **"Gentle Rain"** across multiple developmental domains, weaving thematic connections into every activity, circle-time element, and home connection.*

DEVELOPMENTAL DOMAINS

SENSORY | FINE MOTOR | LANGUAGE | GROSS MOTOR | COGNITIVE

CIRCLE TIME FOCUS

Letter: **R** • Color: **Blue** • Shape: **Circle** • Counting to: **10**

Weekly Objectives

SENSORY Explore water textures and sounds through rain-themed sensory play.

FINE MOTOR Practice pincer grasp by placing raindrops on contact paper.

LANGUAGE Expand weather vocabulary through songs and read-alouds.

GROSS MOTOR Develop balance and coordination with puddle-jump movement activities.

Daily Activities Schedule

Monday

Sensory

Gentle Rain Sensory Bin

Sensory • 20 minutes • *Water and cloud elements directly connect children to the Gentle Rain theme.*

Children explore a water-based sensory bin with blue-tinted water, smooth river stones, and floating foam clouds. This activity introduces the weekly rain theme through tactile exploration and cause-and-effect play.

MATERIALS

- Large plastic bin
- Blue food colouring
- Smooth river stones
- Foam craft clouds
- Plastic cups
- Towels

AGE ADAPTATIONS

0-12m: Place bin on a low mat. Offer only large, soft items for mouthing.

- Use only large foam pieces
- Limit water depth to 1 inch

12-24m: Encourage pouring and scooping with cups.

- Add plastic funnels
- Model pouring actions

24-36m: Introduce counting stones and colour-sorting clouds.

- Add numbered stones
- Ask sorting questions

> **Safety:** Supervise water play at all times. Remove small stones when infants are present. Keep towels nearby for spills.

Reflection: *Which children showed sustained interest? • Were water safety protocols followed?*

Rain Sounds Listening Station

Sensory • 10 minutes • *Authentic rain sounds immerse children in the Gentle Rain theme.*

A calm listening area where children hear recorded rain sounds and identify different types of rain — drizzle, downpour, and thunder. Develops auditory discrimination.

MATERIALS

- Bluetooth speaker
- Rain sounds playlist
- Soft cushions
- Picture cards of rain types

AGE ADAPTATIONS

0-12m: Hold infant close and gently sway to rain rhythms.

- Use softest volume setting

12-24m: Show picture cards and name rain types.

- Point and label together

24-36m: Ask children to match sounds to picture cards.

- Introduce 'loud' vs 'quiet' vocabulary

> **Safety:** Keep volume at a comfortable level. Ensure speaker cords are out of reach.

Reflection: *Did children differentiate between rain sounds?*

Tuesday

Fine Motor

Raindrop Sticker Art

Fine Motor • 15 minutes • *Raindrop shapes reinforce the Gentle Rain visual theme.*

Children peel and place blue raindrop stickers onto a cloud-shaped contact paper sheet. Practices pincer grasp and hand-eye coordination while creating a rain-themed artwork.

MATERIALS

- Blue dot stickers
- Cloud-shaped contact paper
- Cardstock backing
- Tape

AGE ADAPTATIONS

0-12m: Tape contact paper to tray; let infants pat and press.

- Secure paper firmly
- Use largest stickers only

12-24m: Demonstrate peeling and placing one at a time.

- Pre-peel sticker edges for easier grip

24-36m: Encourage creating patterns or counting raindrops.

- Add number labels
- Introduce patterns

Safety: Monitor sticker use to prevent mouthing. Use large stickers (1.5 inch+) for youngest children.

Reflection: *Which children demonstrated pincer grasp? • Was the sticker size appropriate for each age group?*

Wednesday

Language

Rain Story Retelling

Language • 15 minutes • *The read-aloud directly explores rain, connecting literacy to the weekly theme.*

After reading 'Rain!' by Linda Ashman, children retell the story using felt board pieces (umbrella, rain cloud, puddle, child). Develops narrative skills and sequencing.

MATERIALS

- 'Rain!' by Linda Ashman
- Felt board
- Felt weather pieces
- Story sequence cards

AGE ADAPTATIONS

0-12m: Hold book and point to large pictures. Let infant touch felt pieces.

- Use board books only
- One piece at a time

12-24m: Name characters and objects. Encourage pointing.

- Use 3-4 key felt pieces
- Repeat key phrases

24-36m: Ask 'what happens next?' questions. Encourage full sentences.

- Use all felt pieces
- Introduce sequence cards

Safety: Ensure felt pieces are large enough to prevent choking. Supervise felt board use.

Reflection: *Which children attempted retelling? • Were sequence cards helpful for older toddlers?*

Thursday

Gross Motor

Indoor Puddle Jumping

Gross Motor • 15 minutes • *Puddle jumping brings the rain theme to life through whole-body movement.*

Blue paper 'puddles' are placed on the floor. Children practice jumping, stepping, and balancing across them. Develops bilateral coordination and spatial awareness.

MATERIALS

- Blue construction paper (large sheets)
- Non-slip tape
- Masking tape for boundaries

AGE ADAPTATIONS

0-12m: Place infant on tummy on a blue mat for 'puddle' sensory time.
- No jumping — tummy time on textured blue mat

12-24m: Hold hands and step onto puddles together.
- Place puddles close together
- Offer two-hand support

24-36m: Encourage two-foot jumping and counting puddles.
- Space puddles further apart
- Add counting challenge

Safety: Secure all paper puddles with non-slip tape. Clear surrounding area of obstacles. Spot younger children during jumping.

Reflection: *Which children demonstrated two-foot jumping? • Were non-slip measures effective?*

Friday

Cognitive

Cloud in a Jar Experiment

Cognitive • 20 minutes • *This experiment models real rain formation, deepening understanding of the Gentle Rain theme.*

Using a jar filled with water and shaving cream 'clouds', children drop blue food colouring onto the cream to watch 'rain' fall through. Introduces cause-and-effect and simple science concepts.

MATERIALS

- Clear glass jars
- Shaving cream
- Blue food colouring
- Pipettes
- Tray for spills

AGE ADAPTATIONS

0-12m: Observe from a safe distance. Educator demonstrates at eye level.
- Observation only
- Describe what's happening verbally

12-24m: Educator guides pipette use hand-over-hand.
- Use large pipettes
- One drop at a time

24-36m: Children use pipettes independently and predict what will happen.
- Ask prediction questions
- Let child add multiple drops

Safety: Educator handles jars and food colouring. Children only use pipettes with supervision. Shaving cream is non-toxic but should not be ingested.

Reflection: *Did children show surprise or understanding of cause-and-effect? • Were predictions attempted by older toddlers?*

Weather Sorting Activity

Cognitive • 10 minutes • *Sorting weather types contextualises rain within the broader weather family.*

Children sort picture cards into categories: rain, sun, snow, wind. Develops classification skills and weather vocabulary.

MATERIALS

- Laminated weather picture cards
- Sorting trays (4)
- Label cards

AGE ADAPTATIONS

0-12m: Show two contrasting cards (rain vs sun) and name them.

- Two cards only
- Use exaggerated voice

12-24m: Sort into two categories with support.

- Rain vs not-rain sorting
- Hand-over-hand guidance

24-36m: Sort all four categories independently.

- Full 4-category sort
- Add written labels

Safety: Ensure cards are laminated and large enough to prevent choking.

Reflection: *Which children could sort independently?*

Circle Time Overview

LETTER	COLOR	SHAPE	COUNTING TO
R	**Blue**	**Circle**	**10**

Greeting Song: Good Morning Rain Song for Toddlers

▶ Watch on YouTube

Duration: 2:14

> *Hello, hello, hello rainy day friends!*
> *The clouds are soft, the rain descends.*
> *We'll splash and play and sing all day,*
> *Hello, hello, hello rainy day friends!*

Goodbye Song: Goodbye Rain Goodbye Song for Kids

▶ Watch on YouTube

Duration: 1:47

> *Raindrops falling, soft and slow,*
> *Time to wave and time to go.*
> *We learned and played the rainy way,*
> *See you on another day!*

Yoga & Mindful Movement

Tree Pose

Tree Pose

1. Stand tall like a strong tree in the rain.
2. Lift one foot and place it on your opposite ankle.
3. Raise your arms like branches reaching for the clouds.
4. Hold for 5 breaths, then switch sides.

Imagine rain tickling your leaves! • Sway gently like a tree in a storm.

Cat-Cow Pose

1. Get on all fours like a cat.
2. Arch your back up high like a scared cat (Cat).
3. Then drop your tummy low and look up (Cow).
4. Move slowly back and forth 5 times.

Meow like a cat hiding from the rain! • Moo like a cow splashing in puddles!

Downward Facing Dog Pose

1. Start on all fours.
2. Push your hips up high into the sky.
3. Straighten your legs and press your heels down.
4. Look back between your legs and wag your tail!

You're a puppy shaking off the rain! • Can you bark while staying in the pose?

Read-Aloud Recommendation

Rain! by Linda Ashman — A lyrical picture book about a rainy day, supporting weather vocabulary and sequencing.

Discussion Prompt

What sounds do you hear when it rains? What does rain feel like on your skin?

Materials & Supplies Checklist

All materials needed for this week's activities, collected and deduplicated for easy prep.

- [ ] 'Rain!' by Linda Ashman
- [ ] Blue construction paper (large sheets)
- [ ] Blue dot stickers
- [ ] Blue food colouring
- [ ] Bluetooth speaker
- [ ] Cardstock backing
- [ ] Clear glass jars
- [ ] Cloud-shaped contact paper
- [ ] Felt board
- [ ] Felt weather pieces
- [ ] Foam craft clouds
- [ ] Label cards
- [ ] Laminated weather picture cards
- [ ] Large plastic bin
- [ ] Masking tape for boundaries
- [ ] Non-slip tape
- [ ] Picture cards of rain types
- [ ] Pipettes
- [ ] Plastic cups
- [ ] Rain sounds playlist
- [ ] Shaving cream
- [ ] Smooth river stones
- [ ] Soft cushions
- [ ] Sorting trays (4)
- [ ] Story sequence cards
- [ ] Tape
- [ ] Towels
- [ ] Tray for spills

Parent Newsletter

Welcome

Dear Families, this week we explored the wonders of Gentle Rain! Your little ones discovered how rain sounds, feels, and nourishes our world through sensory play, art, movement, and science experiments.

This Week's Learning Goals

- ✓ Explored water textures and rain sounds through sensory experiences
- ✓ Practiced fine motor skills with raindrop sticker art
- ✓ Expanded weather vocabulary through stories and songs
- ✓ Developed gross motor coordination with puddle-jumping games
- ✓ Learned about cause-and-effect with our Cloud in a Jar experiment

Home Connection

> Try going outside during a light rain together! Listen to the sounds, feel the droplets, and talk about what you observe. You can also make your own 'cloud in a jar' at home with a clear glass, shaving cream, and food colouring.

Family-Friendly Version

What a wonderful rainy week we had! 🌧️ Your kiddos were absolute scientists this week — dropping 'rain' into cloud jars, jumping through puddles, and singing rain songs at the top of their lungs. Ask them to show you the Tree Pose we learned in yoga — they're getting so strong! Can't wait for next week's adventures!

Documentation & Observation Checklist

Developmental Observations

- ☐ Physical development (gross & fine motor)
- ☐ Cognitive growth (problem-solving, exploration)
- ☐ Language development (communication, vocabulary)
- ☐ Social-emotional skills (interaction, regulation)
- ☐ Creative expression (art, music, movement)
- ☐ Self-help skills (independence, routines)

Photo Documentation

- ☐ Individual child engagement
- ☐ Group activities
- ☐ Completed art projects
- ☐ Circle time participation
- ☐ Outdoor exploration
- ☐ Special moments